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SECURITY



Russian government hackers said to be behind US federal court filing system hack: Report

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai, Zack Whittaker

1:26 PM PDT · August 12, 2025

The Russian government is allegedly behind the data breach affecting the U.S. court filing system known as PACER, [according to The New York Times](#).

Citing anonymous sources, the newspaper said Russia “is at least in part responsible” for the cyberattack, without saying what part of the Russian government is behind the hack.

The hackers searched for “midlevel criminal cases in the New York City area and several other jurisdictions, with some cases involving people with Russian and Eastern European surnames,” per the article.

Last week, [Politico reported](#) that hackers had broken into the federal judiciary’s electronic case filing system, potentially accessing the identities of confidential informants, which are redacted and not publicly known, putting those people at risk of retaliation from the criminals they are helping authorities apprehend.

IMAGE CREDITS: BRYCE DURBIN / TECHCRUNCH

Politico reported that the stolen data could include sealed criminal dockets and indictments, arrest warrants, and other documents not yet public, or may never actually be included in public dockets.

The Administrative Office of the U.S. Courts, the agency that oversees the U.S. federal court system, [confirmed a cyberattack](#) in a statement on August 7.

The New York Times also quoted a memo sent to Justice Department officials, clerks, and chief judges by the court system’s administrators, which said that “persistent and sophisticated cyber threat actors have recently compromised sealed records.” The email said “this remains an URGENT MATTER that requires immediate action.”

This may not be Russia’s first rodeo targeting the U.S. federal court system.

In 2020, a long-running Russian cyberattack targeted the SolarWinds software, used by large tech companies and government agencies, to [deliver a tainted software update](#)



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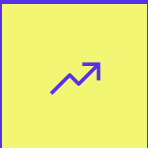
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allowing Russian government hackers backdoor access to the networks of SolarWinds customers.

The widespread hack affected several U.S. government departments, including PACER, allowing the theft of sealed court documents.

The U.S. Courts, in its statement on August 7, said that the agency was “enhancing security of the system and to block future attacks, and it is prioritizing working with courts to mitigate the impact on litigants.”

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Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai is a Senior Writer at TechCrunch, where he covers hacking, cybersecurity, surveillance, and privacy....

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HR giant Workday says hackers stole personal data in recent breach

Zack Whittaker — 6:04 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Workday, one of the largest providers of human resources technology, has confirmed a data breach that allowed hackers to steal personal information from one of its third-party customer relationship databases.

In a [blog post published late Friday](#), the HR technology giant said the [hackers stole an unspecified amount of personal information from the database](#), which Workday said was primarily used to store contact information, such as names, email addresses, and phone numbers.

Workday did not explicitly rule out that customer information was taken in the data breach, stating only that there was “no indication of access to customer tenants or the data within them,” which corporate customers typically use to store the bulk of their human resources files and employees’ personal data.

The company said the stolen information may be used to further social engineering scams, where hackers trick or threaten victims into giving them access to sensitive data.

Workday has more than 11,000 corporate customers, serving at least 70 million users around the world, [per the company’s website](#). Bleeping Computer [reports](#) that the hack was discovered on August 6.

Workday did not identify the breached third-party customer database platform, but follows in a recent spate of

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cyberattacks targeting Salesforce-hosted databases used by large companies to store customer data. In recent weeks, [Google](#), [Cisco](#), [airline giant Qantas](#), and [retailer Pandora](#) have all had reams of data stolen from their Salesforce databases.

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Google attributed the breaches to ShinyHunters, a group of hackers known for using voice phishing to steal corporate data by tricking company employees into granting them access to their cloud-based databases. Google said ShinyHunters was likely in the process of preparing a data leak site to extort its victims into paying the hackers to delete the data, akin to how ransomware gangs operate.

Connor Spielmaker, a spokesperson for Workday, did not comment beyond Workday's blog post or answer TechCrunch's questions, including whether Workday knows how many individuals had data stolen or who the stolen data relates to, such as Workday employees or Workday's corporate customers. Workday would not say if it has the technical means, such as logs, to determine what customer data was exfiltrated.

As of the time of publication, Workday's blog post [disclosing the breach](#) contained a hidden "noindex" tag in its source code, which instructs search engines to ignore the page, making it difficult for anyone searching the web to find the page.

It's not clear for what reason Workday is hiding its data breach notification from search engines.

Do you know more about the Workday data breach or attacks targeting Salesforce databases? Have you been notified about a data breach? Securely contact this reporter via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337](#) on Signal.

Updated with a response from Workday.

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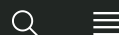
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Zack Whittaker — 3:26 PM PDT · August 18, 2025

The July data breach at U.S. insurance giant Allianz Life allowed hackers to steal the personal information of 1.1 million customers, according to data breach notification site Have I Been Pwned.

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Allianz Life disclosed the data breach in late July, confirming that hackers stole the personal information of [the “majority” of its 1.4 million customers](#) and its employees from a cloud-stored customer relationship database. Allianz has so far refused to confirm exactly how many people are affected by the breach.

Have I Been Pwned, a [data breach notification site](#) that alerts people when their email address has been caught up in data breaches, said [in a post on Monday](#) the Allianz Life breach includes customers’ names, gender, date of birth, email and home addresses, and phone numbers from a database hosted by cloud giant Salesforce.

Allianz Life later told the states of Texas and Massachusetts the hackers also [stole Social Security numbers](#) in the breach.

Brett Weinberg, a spokesperson for Allianz Life, declined to comment to TechCrunch as the company’s investigation is ongoing.

Allianz Life is one of a series of tech and corporate giants that have been targeted in recent months by a hacking crew known as ShinyHunters, a group known for their social engineering skills aimed at tricking employees into granting them access to the company’s databases.

[Google](#), [Cisco](#), [airline giant Qantas](#), and [retailer Pandora](#) — and also [HR giant Workday, as reported by TechCrunch on Monday](#) — have also reported recent data thefts related to their Salesforce-hosted data.

The ShinyHunters gang is said to be preparing a data leak site in an attempt to extort victims into paying the hackers to delete the data, a tactic often employed by ransomware gangs. The group reportedly overlaps with other hacking and crime groups, [including Scattered Spider](#) and [The Com](#), a known collective of cybercriminals who use hacking, extortion, and sometimes threats of violence to break into networks.

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IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

APPS



X’s declining Android app installs are hurting subscription revenue

Sarah Perez — 1:49 PM PDT · August 18, 2025

Elon Musk’s X is struggling on Android devices in terms of new installs, even while App Store downloads grow, according to

new data from app intelligence provider Appfigures. In July 2025, X downloads on Google Play saw a significant decline, as new installs dropped by 44% year-over-year worldwide, even as iOS downloads grew by 15%.

This steep drop in installs is pulling down X's overall average, leading to a 26% decrease in total mobile downloads year-over-year as of July. That's still slightly better than the month prior, when total downloads had fallen by 35%, thanks to another sharp drop in Android downloads, which were then down by nearly half (49%) year-over-year.

New X Downloads on Mobile by Month

Estimated Downloads • Worldwide • App Store and Google Play



IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

The firm didn't speculate on what's causing the decline on Android devices beyond suggesting that the X app on Android is known to be a sore spot for the company. Recently hired [X head of product Nikita Bier](#), known for growth hacking teen social apps like [Gas](#) and [TBH](#) (then [selling them](#)), has hinted that X is looking to address issues on Android, where its app is [notoriously buggy](#) and [often crashes](#).

In a post on the platform, Bier [announced](#) that X was hiring for its "Android Dream Team" to work on rebuilding the X Android app. He also recently posted that X's iOS app [had just seen a record week in terms of installs](#), perhaps hoping to draw attention away from the large Android slump.

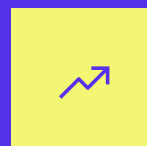
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IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

It's not clear where would-be X Android users are going. Rival Bluesky has seen slowing growth in recent months, and its Google Play app pulled in just 119,000 downloads in July. That's nowhere near the millions that install X on iOS or Android every month. However, Meta's Threads daily active users have been [catching up to X on mobile devices](#), so, possibly, some Android users could be accounted for there.

In addition to the drop in Google Play installs, X is struggling to grow its subscription revenue, Appfigures found.

In July, X earned \$16.9 million in net revenue, down from the \$18.8 million it earned in March 2025. However, that was a slight tick up from the \$16.8 million it generated in June. (Of course, X still earns the majority of its overall revenue from ads, not in-app premium subscriptions.)

While the declining demand for X on Android is partially to blame for revenue declines, X is also likely losing paying customers to Grok. The latter now has its own [stand-alone app](#) that attracts those who were buying X subscriptions primarily for the AI perks.

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Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having previously spent over three years at...

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